

A CYBER-AWARENESS CARD GAME

HUMAN FIREWALL

Everyday cyber risks, real decisions, no jargon. A discussion-driven game for the whole team.

38 Scenario Cards · 7 Role Cards · 14 Event Cards · 5 Decision Cards · Score Tracker · Facilitator Guide

Built for HR · Finance · Sales · Execs · Admin · New Hires · Remote Workers

What this game is

Human Firewall turns cyber-security awareness into a 30–45 minute table conversation. A scenario lands — a suspicious email, an urgent call, a found USB stick — and the team decides how to react. The facilitator reveals what happens, the score moves, and everyone learns through consequences instead of slides.

The one rule that teaches everything: when something is urgent, unexpected and asks for money, data or access — slow down and verify it through a channel you already trust.

Who it's for

Designed for non-technical staff: HR, finance, sales, executives, administrative teams, brand-new hires and remote workers. No security background is needed to play or to facilitate.

What players practise

- **Spotting** everyday attacks: phishing, fake invoices, QR scams, MFA fatigue, deepfake calls, smishing and more.
- **Deciding** calmly under pressure using five simple choices.
- **Habits** that scale: verify out of band, report early, never share codes, badge everyone in.
- **Communication**: who to check with, and how to raise a concern without fear.

Components & setup

In the kit

- **38 Scenario cards** — the heart of the game. Most are attacks, but some are legitimate requests and some are deliberately ambiguous, so players must read each situation rather than reflex-report.
- **7 Role cards** — each player takes a workplace role with its own attack profile and one special ability.
- **14 Event cards** — pressure and reward twists the facilitator can drop in.
- **5 Decision cards** — TRUST, VERIFY, REPORT, IGNORE, ESCALATE (print one set per player).
- **Score Tracker** — four team meters plus a 10-incident log.
- **Outcomes Key** — facilitator-only answers for every scenario (keep this hidden from players).

Setup (about 5 minutes)

- 1 Pick a facilitator.** They run the round, keep the Outcomes Key, and move the score. They don't 'win' — they coach.
- 2 Deal a role** to each player (2–6 players is ideal; larger groups split into teams).
- 3 Give every player a set of Decision cards** so they can show their choice.
- 4 Set the meters** on the Score Tracker to their starting values, and shuffle the Scenario and Event decks separately.

How a round works

- 1 Draw a Scenario.** The facilitator reads it aloud. It usually targets a specific role — that player leads, but everyone joins in.
- 2 Discuss (1–2 min).** Is it real? How would you check? Who should approve? This conversation is where the learning happens.
- 3 Decide.** The lead player (or the team) plays one Decision card face-up.
- 4 Reveal the consequence.** The facilitator reads the matching outcome from the Outcomes Key and adjusts the meters.
- 5 Share the learning point** from the key, then move to the next incident. Drop in an Event card whenever you want to raise the pressure.

The four meters

All four are tracked for the whole team — you win or lose together.

Reputation 70
Public & customer trust. 0 = ruined.

Funds 100k
Company money. 0 = bankrupt.

Security Score 60
How hardened you are. 0 = wide open.

Stress 30
Team pressure — **lower is better**. 100 = burnout.

Win (Cooperative): survive 20 incidents with Reputation ≥ 50 , Funds > 0 , Security ≥ 40 and Stress ≤ 80 .

Instant loss if any meter hits its danger point: Funds 0 (bankrupt), Reputation 0 (ruined), Security 0 (fully breached) or Stress 100 (the team burns out).

Final rating: 80–100 Security = “Human Firewall ★★★” · 60–79 = “Security-Aware ★★” · 40–59 = “Getting There ★”.

Two ways to play

Cooperative Mode (default — best for workshops)

Everyone protects the company together against the deck. Discuss openly and aim for the best collective call on each incident.

Speed Round (great for energy)

Teams have 60 seconds per scenario to discuss and commit a Decision — no outcome is revealed until the timer ends. Rewards instinct and exposes the gut-reaction “just click it” habit.

Facilitator tips

- **Let the wrong answer happen.** A bad outcome with a calm debrief teaches more than steering players to the ‘right’ card.
- **Ask “how would you verify?”** every round until it becomes a reflex.
- **Make reporting safe.** Reward REPORT generously and never mock a near-miss — in real life, fear of blame is what hides breaches.
- **Tie it back to your tools.** Name your real report-phishing button, your IT number and your payment-approval process during the debrief.
- **Keep it to ~60 minutes.** Twenty incidents plus a short debrief makes a full session.

Adapting to your industry

Swap a few scenario themes to make it hit home. Same mechanics, familiar context:

Sector	Tailor scenarios toward...
Hospitals & Clinics	Fake patient-record requests, ‘doctor’ calls for urgent prescriptions, vendor invoice fraud.
Banks & Finance	Wire-transfer fraud, fake regulator emails, ‘account verification’ phishing.
Schools & Universities	Parent/teacher phishing, fake fee-payment links, student-data requests.
Retail	POS malware, fake supplier invoices, gift-card scams, QR menu/payment scams.
Shipping & Logistics	Fake customs emails, courier SMS scams, redirected-payment invoice fraud.
Law & Professional Services	Client-impersonation, confidential-document requests, deepfake partner calls.

Later expansions can add a mobile app, Microsoft Teams integration, AI-generated practice phishing, and company-customised scenario packs.

Outcomes Key — Facilitator only, keep hidden

For each scenario, read the outcome that matches the Decision the team played, apply the meter changes, then share the learning point. Funds changes are shown in 'k' (thousands).

PHISHING

Scenario #01

The Password Reset

ATTACK

TRUST

You enter your password on the fake page. Credentials stolen — the attacker logs in.

Sec -20

Rep -10

Stress +15

VERIFY

You hover the link, see a strange domain, and open the real portal yourself. No harm done.

Sec +5

REPORT

You use 'Report Phishing'. Security blocks the sender for the whole company.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You delete it. You're safe, but colleagues still receive the same trap.

no change

ESCALATE

Your manager confirms it's fake. Minor delay, no harm.

Sec +5

Stress +5

Best move: REPORT (or VERIFY)

Learning point: Real providers never ask you to confirm a password through an email link — go to the site yourself, or report it.

The Breach Notice

ATTACK

TRUST You assume it's fine and change nothing. Attackers reuse the password and break into your email.

Sec -20

Funds -10k

Stress +15

VERIFY You confirm the alert is really from IT, then realise the risk. Good caution.

Sec +5

REPORT You tell security, who force a reset before anyone gets in.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You move on. The reused password is quietly abused weeks later.

Sec -10

Stress +10

ESCALATE You ask IT to reset everywhere and switch on MFA and a password manager.

Sec +15

Funds -5k

Stress -5

Best move: ESCALATE / REPORT

Learning point: One leaked password unlocks everything if you reuse it — use unique passwords and a password manager.

Approve? Approve? Approve?

ATTACK

TRUST You tap Approve just to make it stop. The attacker is now inside your account.

Sec -20

Rep -5

Stress +15

VERIFY You check the location and time, see it isn't you, and deny it.

Sec +5

REPORT You deny it and alert security. They lock the account and block the attacker.

Sec +15

Stress -5

IGNORE You deny and silence your phone. The attack stops, but no one is warned.

Sec +5

Stress +5

ESCALATE You call IT, who reset your credentials immediately.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: Never approve a login prompt you didn't start — repeated prompts are an attack. Deny and report.

Scan to Pay

ATTACK

TRUST

You scan and enter your card. The details are stolen on a fake page.

Sec -10

Funds -15k

Stress +10

VERIFY

You use the meter's official app instead of the sticker. Safe.

Sec +5

REPORT

You tell facilities/security. The fake sticker is removed and others are protected.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You ignore it and pay another way. No harm to you.

no change

ESCALATE

Facilities investigate where the sticker came from.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT**Learning point:** A QR code hides where it really goes — don't scan random ones in public; use the official app or site.

The Bank Details Changed

ATTACK

TRUST

You pay the new account. The money goes straight to a fraudster.

Rep -10

Funds -25k

Stress +15

VERIFY

You call the supplier on the number you already have. The change is fake.

Sec +5

REPORT

You flag it to security and finance. The fraud is caught and others are warned.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You don't pay at all. Awkward with a real supplier, but no money lost.

Rep -5

Stress +5

ESCALATE

Dual approval catches the mismatch before payment.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (call a known number)**Learning point:** Always confirm changed bank details by calling a number you already trust — never the one on the invoice.

The Found Drive

ATTACK

TRUST

You plug it in. Malware runs automatically and spreads onto the network.

Sec -20

Funds -10k

Stress +15

VERIFY

There's no safe way to 'check' it by plugging in — you treat it as suspicious.

Sec +5

REPORT

You hand it to IT, who examine it safely in isolation.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You bin it. Safe, but a possible drop attack goes unreported.

no change

ESCALATE

IT investigate a possible 'USB drop' targeting the office.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: 'USB drop' attacks bait your curiosity — never plug in a drive you found. Hand it to IT.

The CEO's Voice

ATTACK

TRUST

You make the transfer. The voice was AI-cloned; the funds are gone.

Rep -10

Funds -25k

Stress +20

VERIFY

You call the CEO back on a known number (or use your code word). It's fake.

Sec +5

REPORT

You flag the attempt to security. The team is warned about voice-clone fraud.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You hang up. Safe, but the attempt isn't reported.

Stress +5

ESCALATE

You require the normal payment-approval process, which stops it.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (call back on a trusted number)

Learning point: AI can clone a voice. Urgency + secrecy + money is the scam pattern — always verify on a known channel.

The Helpful Post

ATTACK**TRUST**

The post stays up. Attackers harvest the details for a targeted phishing attack.

Sec -10

Rep -5

Stress +5

VERIFY

You check exactly what's visible in the photo first.

Sec +5

REPORT

You quietly flag it; the post is taken down and friendly guidance is given.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

The post stays public and the risk remains.

Sec -5

ESCALATE

You ask a manager to clarify the social-media policy for everyone.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT (and coach them)

Learning point: Badges, screens and 'behind the scenes' posts leak details attackers use. Think before you post.

Your Files Are Locked

ATTACK**TRUST**

You pay the ransom. There's no guarantee of recovery — and you're now a known payer.

Sec -10

Funds -25k

Stress +20

VERIFY

You don't negotiate alone — you get help before doing anything.

no change

REPORT

You disconnect the device and call IT at once. The spread is contained; backups restore the files.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You keep working. The ransomware spreads to shared drives.

Sec -20

Stress +15

ESCALATE

Incident response and leadership coordinate a clean recovery — no payment.

Sec +15

Funds -5k

Best move: REPORT (disconnect & call IT)

Learning point: Don't pay and don't panic — isolate the device and call IT. Good backups beat ransoms.

Send Me Payroll

ATTACK

TRUST

You send the file. The account was hijacked — employee data is leaked.

Sec -15

Rep -15

Stress +15

VERIFY

You reach your manager another way and learn their account was compromised.

Sec +10

REPORT

You flag the account to IT, who secure it before more damage is done.

Sec +15

Stress -5

IGNORE

You don't send it, but the hijacked account stays active and dangerous.

Sec -5

ESCALATE

Manager and security are looped in and the account is locked.

Sec +10

Best move: VERIFY, then REPORT

Learning point: Even a trusted account can be hijacked — verify unusual data requests through another channel.

A Message from the Boss

ATTACK

TRUST

You reply and help, and get drawn into a gift-card / transfer scam.

Rep -5

Funds -10k

Stress +10

VERIFY

You confirm with the CEO's real contact — the account is fake.

Sec +5

REPORT

You report the impersonation; the account is taken down and staff are warned.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You ignore it. Safe for you; others may still be targeted.

no change

ESCALATE

Comms and security alert all staff to the fake account.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: Impersonation accounts copy names and photos — verify identity before acting on 'confidential' asks.

IT Support Calling

ATTACK

TRUST

You install the 'fix' and grant access. The caller now controls your PC.

Sec -20

Stress +15

VERIFY

You hang up and call IT on the number you know. There's no such ticket.

Sec +5

REPORT

You report the call so security can warn others.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You hang up and move on. Safe.

Stress +5

ESCALATE

IT investigate the spoofed support call.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (call IT back yourself)

Learning point: Real IT won't cold-call you for remote access — hang up and call the number you already know.

Hold the Door

ATTACK

TRUST

You hold the door. An unauthorised stranger is now inside the building.

Sec -15

Stress +10

VERIFY

You politely point them to reception to sign in. They had no business there.

Sec +10

REPORT

You alert security, who check and escort them.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You let the door close behind you. Safe-ish, but no one is alerted.

no change

ESCALATE

Reception verifies whether they have an appointment.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (send them to reception)

Learning point: 'Tailgating' bypasses all your tech security — everyone badges in, no exceptions, however polite.

There's an App for That

ATTACK

TRUST

You upload the data. The client list is now in the hands of an unknown third party.

Sec -10

Rep -10

Stress +5

VERIFY

You check with IT whether the tool is approved — it isn't, so you find a safe option.

Sec +5

REPORT

You ask IT to vet it; they approve a safe alternative.

Sec +10

IGNORE

You stick with the approved process. No harm done.

no change

ESCALATE

IT review and provide a sanctioned tool.

Sec +10

Best move: VERIFY / ESCALATE with IT

Learning point: Free 'helpful' tools can harvest your data — check with IT before uploading any company information.

Enable Content to View

ATTACK

TRUST

You enable content. Hidden macro malware runs on your machine.

Sec -20

Stress +15

VERIFY

You weren't expecting it, so you don't enable anything and check the sender.

Sec +5

REPORT

You report it as phishing; the sender is blocked.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You close the file. Safe.

no change

ESCALATE

IT examine the file in a safe environment.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT (don't enable content)

Learning point: 'Enable content' on an unexpected document can run hidden malware — when in doubt, report it.

Left on the Train

ATTACK

TRUST

You wait and hope it turns up. The data is exposed if the wrong person finds it.

Sec -10

Rep -10

Stress +15

VERIFY

You retrace your steps and check lost property — but every minute counts.

Stress +5

REPORT

You tell IT immediately; they remote-lock and wipe it before anyone can access it.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You say nothing. The unsecured laptop becomes a breach.

Sec -15

Rep -15

Stress +15

ESCALATE

IT and your manager handle containment and any disclosure.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT (fast, so IT can wipe it)

Learning point: Report lost devices immediately — a quick remote lock or wipe turns a disaster into a non-event.

From the New Auditor

ATTACK

TRUST

You send the list. It's used to build a convincing mass-phishing campaign.

Sec -15

Rep -5

Stress +10

VERIFY

You confirm with your own finance/audit contact — there is no such auditor.

Sec +10

REPORT

You report the call; staff are warned of the pretext.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE

You don't send anything. Safe.

no change

ESCALATE

A manager verifies whether any audit is actually engaged.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (through your own contact)

Learning point: 'Officials' who pressure you for staff data are a classic pretext — verify through a contact you already trust.

Read Me Your Code

ATTACK

TRUST

You read the code aloud. That code was the key — the attacker completes their login.

Sec -15

Funds -20k

Stress +15

VERIFY

You hang up and call the bank on the number on your card. It's a scam.

Sec +10

REPORT

You report the call and freeze the account.

Sec +5

Stress -5

IGNORE

You hang up. Safe.

Stress +5

ESCALATE

You loop in your bank's verified fraud line.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (never share a code)

Learning point: No real bank or service ever asks you to read back a one-time code — that code unlocks your account.

The Monthly Invoice

LEGITIMATE

TRUST

You pay it through the normal process. The supplier is paid on time and the relationship stays healthy.

Rep +5

VERIFY

You quickly match it against the purchase order before paying. Prudent — costs a moment.

Stress +5

REPORT

You flag it as fraud. Security investigates, finds nothing, and a real supplier is left waiting.

Rep -5

Stress +10

IGNORE

You don't pay. The genuine supplier chases late fees and the relationship sours.

Rep -10

Funds -10k

Stress +10

ESCALATE

You bump a routine payment up the chain. Fine, just slower than it needed to be.

Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (pay via the normal process)

Learning point: Not everything is an attack. A known supplier, normal channel, unchanged details and a matching PO are signs it's genuine — and paying on time matters too.

Patch Tonight

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You let it run. Your machine stays patched and protected. Sec +10
VERIFY	You confirm it really came from the IT channel. Quick and sensible. no change
REPORT	You report it as phishing. Security spends time confirming their own genuine notice. Stress +10
IGNORE	No action was needed anyway — no harm done. no change
ESCALATE	You escalate a routine notice. Unnecessary, but harmless. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (no links, no credentials, official channel)

Learning point: Real IT messages come through official channels and never ask for passwords or urgent clicks. Spotting a genuine notice avoids alarm fatigue.

The First Morning

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	Payroll is set up correctly and securely. A smooth start. Sec +5
VERIFY	The new hire double-checks they're in the real HR system. Good habit. no change
REPORT	They report their own legitimate onboarding. Awkward, and it stalls their setup. Stress +10
IGNORE	They put it off. Their own payroll setup is delayed. Stress +10
ESCALATE	Unnecessary for a normal in-person setup. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (in person, official system, no links)

Learning point: Compare this with the fake 'confirm your bank details' email: official system, in person, no links. Context separates real from fake.

VERIFIED CUSTOMER
Their Own Account

Scenario #22

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You provide it through the portal. Good service, happy customer. Rep +5
VERIFY	Their identity is already confirmed by the portal, but a quick check doesn't hurt. Stress +5
REPORT	You treat a verified customer as a threat. Security finds nothing and the customer is frustrated. Rep -5 Stress +5
IGNORE	You leave a legitimate request hanging. The customer's experience suffers. Rep -10 Stress +5
ESCALATE	You pass a routine, verified request up the line. Slower service than needed. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (identity verified through the official portal)

Learning point: Security shouldn't block legitimate service. Verified identity through an official channel means you can help with confidence.

SANCTIONED TOOL
A Tool to Try

Scenario #23

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You use the approved tool. Work gets done and the data stays within sanctioned systems. no change
VERIFY	You confirm it's on the approved list first — exactly the right check. Sec +5
REPORT	You report an already-approved tool. A quick dead end for security. Stress +5
IGNORE	You avoid a perfectly safe, approved tool and do it the slow way. Stress +5
ESCALATE	Unnecessary — it's already sanctioned. Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY it's approved, then use it

Learning point: The rule isn't 'never use online tools' — it's 'use approved ones.' Knowing what's sanctioned is the skill.

The Weekly Report

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You send it. Normal request, normal channel — work moves along. no change
VERIFY	You insist on verifying a routine, non-sensitive request. It's safe, but it slows things and signals distrust. Rep -5 Stress +5
REPORT	You report your own manager's normal request. Confusing for everyone. Rep -5 Stress +10
IGNORE	You ignore a reasonable ask from your manager. Not a great look. Rep -5 Stress +5
ESCALATE	You escalate a routine request — unnecessary friction. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (normal channel, normal request, nothing sensitive)

Learning point: Constant suspicion of normal requests grinds work to a halt. Save verification for the red flags: urgency, secrecy, sensitive data, or an unusual channel.

The Urgent Invoice

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST	You pay it as-is. The figure was padded from a compromised supplier mailbox — partly avoidable. Funds -15k Stress +10
VERIFY	One call to the supplier on a known number clears it up before any money moves. Sec +5
REPORT	You escalate to security. A bit heavy for one odd detail, but no harm. Stress +5
IGNORE	You sit on it. If it was genuine, the supplier is now chasing you. Rep -5 Stress +5
ESCALATE	You route it for a second approval — reasonable for an unusual amount. Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY — one quick call resolves the doubt

Learning point: When something is mostly normal but one detail is off (amount, tone, urgency), a 30-second check beats both blindly paying and crying fraud.

Recruiter in Your Inbox

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST You send a full CV with personal details to an unverified stranger. Possibly fine, possibly harvested.

Sec -5

Stress +5

VERIFY You check the recruiter's profile and the company before sharing anything. Sensible.

no change

REPORT You report it. If it was genuine, you may have flagged a real recruiter — minor noise.

Stress +5

IGNORE You ignore it. Safe, though you might pass up a real opportunity.

no change

ESCALATE Not really an escalation matter.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (check the profile and company first)

Learning point: Not malicious by default, not safe by default. Verify the source before handing over personal information.

Sign In Again

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST You type your password straight into the popup. If it was fake, it's now stolen.

Sec -10

Stress +10

VERIFY You close the popup and sign in by opening the app yourself. Safe either way.

Sec +5

REPORT You report it. If real, a little noise; no harm done.

Stress +5

IGNORE You dismiss it and can't use the app until you sign in.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You ask IT — fine, if a touch slow.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (sign in through the app yourself, not the popup)

Learning point: Re-auth prompts are often real — but only ever enter credentials somewhere you navigated to yourself.

Did You Send This?

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST You click it. Their account had been hijacked and the link was malicious — partly avoidable.

Sec -10

Stress +10

VERIFY A quick 'did you send this?' confirms it before you click. Two seconds well spent.

Sec +5

REPORT You report it without asking. If genuine, a small false alarm.

Stress +5

IGNORE You skip it. Safe, but you might miss real work.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You loop in IT — a bit much before a simple check.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (a quick 'did you send this?')

Learning point: Even real colleagues get hijacked. A two-second check before clicking an unexpected link costs nothing.

Forward to Everyone

ATTACK

TRUST You forward it company-wide. Now everyone's inbox carries the panic.

Rep -5

Stress +10

VERIFY You spend time 'checking' an obvious hoax. Harmless, but wasted effort.

Stress +5

REPORT You raise a security ticket for a harmless chain email. Minor noise.

Stress +5

IGNORE You delete it and don't pass it on. The hoax stops with you.

no change

ESCALATE You escalate a hoax to management. Overkill.

Stress +5

Best move: IGNORE (don't forward it)

Learning point: Hoaxes survive by being forwarded. Don't pass them on, don't panic — just delete.

Book a Demo

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You engage, and invite a steady stream of follow-up spam. Stress +5
VERIFY	You research a cold sales email. Time you won't get back. Stress +5
REPORT	You report marketing spam as phishing. Security checks it, finds nothing, and your real reports look less urgent. Stress +5
IGNORE	You delete it (or unsubscribe). Done — it was never a security matter. no change
ESCALATE	You escalate junk mail. Unnecessary. Stress +5

Best move: IGNORE (just delete or unsubscribe)

Learning point: Not every unwanted email is an attack. Marketing spam gets deleted or unsubscribed — it's not a security incident.

The Rude Comment

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST	You fire back in public. The argument escalates and reflects badly on the brand. Rep -10 Stress +10
VERIFY	There's nothing here to verify. Stress +5
REPORT	You report a single rude comment as a security threat — it isn't one. Stress +5
IGNORE	You don't take the bait. With no audience, the comment fizzles out. no change
ESCALATE	You escalate a one-off troll to comms. Save that for real harassment or impersonation. Stress +5

Best move: IGNORE (don't feed the troll)

Learning point: Public trolls want a reaction. Don't engage — escalate only if it turns into harassment or impersonation.

A Stranger Wants to Connect**JUDGMENT CALL**

TRUST You accept and chat freely, handing a stranger a window into your work life.

Sec -5

Stress +5

VERIFY You investigate a random request at length. Disproportionate.

Stress +5

REPORT You report an ordinary stranger as a threat. False alarm.

Stress +5

IGNORE You leave it or decline. No harm, no fuss.

no change

ESCALATE You escalate a connection request. Overkill.

Stress +5

Best move: IGNORE (just decline)

Learning point: A stranger's request isn't a threat to report — decline or ignore it. Save caution for accounts impersonating real people.

You've Won!**ATTACK**

TRUST You click through and start handing over details on a scam page.

Sec -10

Stress +10

VERIFY You waste time 'checking' a lottery you never entered.

Stress +5

REPORT You file a ticket for junk the filter already caught. Save reporting for convincing, targeted messages.

Stress +5

IGNORE You delete it. Obvious junk, already filtered — no ticket needed.

no change

ESCALATE You escalate obvious spam. No need.

Stress +5

Best move: IGNORE (just delete it)

Learning point: Obvious junk that's already in spam doesn't need a ticket — delete it. Reserve reporting for messages that look targeted or convincing.

The Journalist Calls

LEGITIMATE

TRUST You comment on the company's behalf without authority — your words become the story.

Rep -15

Stress +10

VERIFY You can't verify a breach yourself, and that isn't the point.

Stress +5

REPORT You file an IT ticket — wrong channel. This is a comms and leadership matter.

Stress +5

IGNORE You brush them off and tell nobody. Leadership is blindsided when it runs.

Rep -5

Stress +5

ESCALATE You take a message and pass it straight to management / comms. Exactly right.

Rep +5

Best move: ESCALATE (to management / comms)

Learning point: Press, legal and regulator questions go straight to management — never improvise on the company's behalf, and never just sit on them.

A Request for Records

LEGITIMATE

TRUST Even though it's genuine, you release customer data on your own authority — a serious overstep.

Sec -10

Rep -10

Stress +10

VERIFY Confirming it's real is wise — but once it is, you still must escalate, not act alone.

Stress +5

REPORT This isn't a phishing report; it needs an authority decision.

Stress +5

IGNORE You sit on a legitimate regulator request. That invites real trouble.

Rep -10

Stress +10

ESCALATE You route it to management / legal / your data-protection lead for sign-off. Correct.

Sec +5

Best move: ESCALATE (for the right sign-off)

Learning point: Even a legitimate request for sensitive data needs proper authorisation. Confirm it's real, then escalate — don't release data solo.

Working From Home

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You decide it's none of your business — and quietly condone the risk. Sec -10
VERIFY	There's nothing to verify; the behaviour is plain to see. Stress +5
REPORT	You open a formal security incident on a careless but well-meaning colleague — heavier than it needs to be. Stress +5
IGNORE	You let it slide. The data keeps leaving the company unprotected. Sec -10 Stress +10
ESCALATE	You raise it calmly with your manager / security, so it's handled and the person gets support. Sec +10

Best move: ESCALATE (raise it through the right channel)

Learning point: Insider mistakes are a people problem, not a phishing report. Raise them through your manager or security so they're handled constructively.

The Access Request

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You hand over broad admin access with no review — a real exposure, however well-meant. Sec -15 Stress +10
VERIFY	Confirming identity is fine, but the real question is how much access is appropriate. Stress +5
REPORT	Nothing here to report — it isn't a threat, it's an authorisation call. Stress +5
IGNORE	You quietly block a legitimate-looking request and stall the new manager's work. Rep -5 Stress +10
ESCALATE	You route it to the system owner for a least-privilege review and approval. Exactly how big grants should work. Sec +10

Best move: ESCALATE (for least-privilege approval)

Learning point: Genuine-looking, high-impact requests still need the right approval. Escalate big access grants for review rather than granting — or blocking — them yourself.

A Quiet Demand

ATTACK**TRUST**

You engage and arrange payment alone — funding a criminal with no guarantee of anything.

Funds -20k

Stress +15

VERIFY

There's no safe way to 'check' an extortion demand yourself.

Stress +5

REPORT

Logging it helps, but a threat like this needs leadership and incident response, not just a ticket.

Stress +5

IGNORE

You bury a credible threat against the company. If it's real, nobody is ready.

Sec -10

Stress +10

ESCALATE

You take it straight to leadership and incident response. The right people respond as a team.

Sec +5

Best move: ESCALATE (to leadership / incident response)

Learning point: A credible threat against the company goes to leadership and incident response fast — don't pay, don't negotiate, and don't sit on it alone.

Scenario Cards (1 of the deck)

Print, then cut along the borders. Colour bands show the attack channel. Players see only the front — outcomes live in the Outcomes Key.

EMAIL & MESSAGES#01 The Password Reset TARGETS: ANYONE An urgent email “from Microsoft” warns your account will be locked in 24 hours. It tells you to click a link and re-enter your password now. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	DEVICES & TECH#02 The Breach Notice TARGETS: ANYONE IT warns that a website where you used your work password has been breached. The same password also protects your work email. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	DEVICES & TECH#03 Approve? Approve? Approve? TARGETS: ANYONE Your phone buzzes with login-approval requests over and over at 11pm — sign-ins you never started. One more pops up. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.
ON THE GO#04 Scan to Pay TARGETS: ANYONE A sticker on the office parking meter reads “Scan to pay / update card details.” The QR code opens a payment page. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	MONEY & PAYMENTS#05 The Bank Details Changed TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER A known supplier emails a normal-looking invoice, with a note: “Please note our bank account has changed — pay the new account below.” What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	DEVICES & TECH#06 The Found Drive TARGETS: ANYONE You find a USB stick in the car park labelled “Payroll 2025 — Confidential.” Curiosity says plug it in. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHONE & VOICE

#07

The CEO's VoiceTARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER /
ADMIN

A call comes in. It sounds exactly like the CEO: "I'm in a meeting — move €40,000 to this account right now, and keep it quiet."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SOCIAL & ONLINE

#08

The Helpful Post

TARGETS: INTERN / NEW HIRE

An intern proudly posts a first-day photo — their screen, their badge, and "Can't believe how easy our new vendor portal login is!"

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#09

Your Files Are Locked

TARGETS: ANYONE

A red full-screen message appears: "All your files are encrypted. Pay \$2,000 in crypto within 48 hours or lose everything." A colleague says "just pay it!"

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#10

Send Me Payroll

TARGETS: HR MANAGER / FINANCE

A Microsoft Teams message from your manager's account: "Hey, can you send me the payroll spreadsheet urgently? I'm boarding a flight."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SOCIAL & ONLINE

#11

A Message from the Boss

TARGETS: ANYONE

A brand-new account using the CEO's name and photo messages staff: "I need your mobile number for a quick confidential task."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHONE & VOICE

#12

IT Support Calling

TARGETS: ANYONE

A caller says: "This is IT — we've found a virus on your PC. I'll walk you through installing a fix; just grant me remote access."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHYSICAL & IN-PERSON

#13

Hold the Door

TARGETS: RECEPTIONIST / ANYONE

Someone in a delivery uniform, arms full of boxes, smiles at the secure door behind you: "Thanks — could you hold it? I've forgotten my badge."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#14

There's an App for That

TARGETS: SALESPERSON / ANYONE

To work faster, a teammate suggests uploading the full client list to a free online tool they found to 'clean it up.'

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#15

Enable Content to View

TARGETS: ANYONE

An attachment, "Invoice.docx," opens to a banner: "Protected view — Enable Content to see this document."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

ON THE GO

#16

Left on the Train

TARGETS: SALESPERSON

You realise your work laptop — logged in and full of client data — was left on the train.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHONE & VOICE

#17

From the New Auditor

TARGETS: HR MANAGER / FINANCE

A polite caller claims to be a new external auditor and asks you to email a list of all staff names, emails and job titles 'for the audit.'

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHONE & VOICE

#18

Read Me Your Code

TARGETS: ANYONE

Right after a login alert, you get a call: "Hi, your bank's fraud team here. To cancel the suspicious login, read me the 6-digit code we just texted you."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#19

The Monthly Invoice

TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER

A regular monthly invoice lands in the accounts inbox from a supplier you've used for years. Same bank details as always, the usual amount, and it matches an existing purchase order.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#20

Patch Tonight

TARGETS: ANYONE

A message in the official IT channel says a security update will install automatically tonight. No action needed, no links, and it never asks for your password.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHYSICAL & IN-PERSON

#21

The First Morning

TARGETS: INTERN / NEW HIRE / HR

On the new hire's first morning, HR sits with them and sets up payroll directly inside the official HR system — in person, no emails, no external links.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#22

Their Own Account

TARGETS: SALESPERSON / ADMIN

A customer, logged in and identity-verified through your official support portal, asks for a copy of their own account information.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#23

A Tool to Try

TARGETS: ANYONE

A teammate suggests a tool to tidy up a client list. You check, and it's already on IT's approved-software list.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#24

The Weekly Report

TARGETS: ANYONE

Your manager, in your usual work chat thread, asks you to send over a non-sensitive document the two of you share every week.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#25

The Urgent Invoice

TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER

An invoice from a known supplier arrives — bank details unchanged, but the amount is noticeably higher than usual and the tone is pushier and more urgent than their normal emails.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SOCIAL & ONLINE

#26

Recruiter in Your Inbox

TARGETS: ANYONE

A recruiter messages you with a plausible-looking role and asks you to send your CV and contact details. It might be a real opportunity — or a way to harvest your information.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#27

Sign In Again

TARGETS: ANYONE

Right after a genuine software update, an app asks you to sign in again. It could be a normal re-authentication — or a fake prompt placed to catch your password.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#28

Did You Send This?

TARGETS: ANYONE

A coworker drops a document link in chat. You weren't expecting it, but it's plausibly work-related and they often share files.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#29

Forward to Everyone

TARGETS: ANYONE

A well-meaning colleague forwards you a warning: "URGENT — forward this to everyone or Microsoft will shut our email down tomorrow!" It's a classic chain-mail hoax.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#30

Book a Demo

TARGETS: ANYONE

An unsolicited but genuine-looking email from a software vendor wants to book a demo and sell you their product. It's not a scam — just spam you didn't ask for.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SOCIAL & ONLINE

#31

The Rude Comment

TARGETS: SALESPERSON / ADMIN

On the company's public social account, an anonymous user posts a rude, baiting comment clearly designed to provoke a reaction.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SOCIAL & ONLINE

#32

A Stranger Wants to Connect

TARGETS: ANYONE

You get a connection request from someone you don't know — no mutual contacts, a thin generic profile. It isn't impersonating anyone; it's just a stranger.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#33

You've Won!

TARGETS: ANYONE

An email already sitting in your junk folder shouts: "CONGRATULATIONS!!! You've WON \$1,000,000 in a lottery you never entered. Claim within 24 hours!" It's riddled with typos.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHONE & VOICE

#34

The Journalist Calls

TARGETS: RECEPTIONIST / ADMIN / EXECUTIVE

A journalist phones and asks you to confirm whether the company suffered a data breach last week. You're not certain, and it isn't your place to speak for the company.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#35

A Request for Records

TARGETS: HR MANAGER / FINANCE

A request arrives — confirmed genuine through proper channels — from a regulator asking for a set of customer records. It's real, but releasing customer data is a big, high-stakes step.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#36

Working From Home

TARGETS: ANYONE / IT

You notice a teammate routinely emailing unencrypted customer spreadsheets to their personal Gmail so they can work from home. They're not malicious — just careless.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#37

The Access Request

TARGETS: IT / DEVELOPER

A new manager asks — politely, through the proper ticket system — for full admin access to a sensitive system 'to do their job.' The request looks legitimate and follows process, but it's a big privilege to grant.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#38

A Quiet Demand

TARGETS: ANYONE / EXECUTIVE

An email addressed to you personally threatens to leak company data unless you arrange a payment quietly, today. It feels aimed and credible.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

Role Cards

Deal one per player. Each role has its own attack profile and a once-per-game special ability.

ROLE

Receptionist / Front Desk

The first point of contact for every visitor, call and delivery.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Tailgating, suspicious visitors, phone scams.

Special: Gatekeeper — once per game, auto-resolve any physical/visitor scenario as VERIFY (prevented).

ROLE

HR Manager

Holds the personal data of everyone in the company.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Fake onboarding, data requests, payroll phishing.

Special: Records Lock — once per game, cancel one Reputation loss from a data-leak outcome.

ROLE

Finance Officer

Controls payments — the prize attackers want most.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Invoice fraud, business-email compromise, deepfake transfer calls.

Special: Dual Control — once per game, force VERIFY on a money scenario (no Funds lost that round).

ROLE

CEO / Executive

High authority and a public profile — often the person attackers impersonate.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Impersonation and deepfakes (as the faked person), targeted phishing.

Special: Set the Tone — once per game, reduce the team's Stress by 10.

ROLE

Intern / New Hire

Eager to help and still learning what's normal.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Pressure tactics, onboarding scams, oversharing online.

Special: Beginner's Question — once per game, ask the facilitator one yes/no question before deciding.

ROLE

IT / Developer

Keeps the systems running and is trusted with access.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Vishing ('IT support'), malicious files, shadow IT.

Special: Patch It — once per game, turn one REPORT into a guaranteed 'attack prevented.'

ROLE

Salesperson

Always on the move, with lots of external contact and devices.

OFTEN TARGETED BY

Public Wi-Fi, lost devices, QR scams.

Special: Road Warrior — once per game, ignore one Stress penalty.

Event Cards

The facilitator drops these in to add pressure (or the occasional reward).

EVENT IT Is Overloaded Any REPORT this round takes effect next round instead of now.	EVENT The CEO Is on Vacation You can't verify with the CEO this round: +5 Stress on any CEO-related scenario.	EVENT Journalist Calls If Reputation is below 60, lose 5 more Reputation. Otherwise, no effect.
EVENT Customer Complains Online Reputation -5 immediately.	EVENT Payday Rush Finance is slammed — the next money scenario adds +5 Stress.	EVENT Audit Week Good security calls this round earn +5 extra Security Score.
EVENT System Outage Everyone's Stress +10.	EVENT Budget Cuts Funds -10.	EVENT Awareness Training Done Reward: Security +10 and Stress -5.
EVENT Holiday Scam Surge Draw and resolve TWO scenario cards this round.	EVENT Phishing Simulation Your own security team sends a test. Resolve the next scenario with no Funds penalty.	EVENT New-Starter Week Every scenario this round targets the Intern / New Hire if possible.

EVENT

Backups Verified

Reward: the next REPORT on a ransomware/malware scenario fully prevents it.

EVENT

VIP Visit

Reputation is fragile — any TRUST mistake this round costs +5 extra Reputation.

Decision Cards

Print one set per player. These are the only five choices anyone ever needs.

DECISION

TRUST

Do exactly what the message or caller asks. Comply with the request.

DECISION

VERIFY

Independently confirm through a second, trusted channel before acting.

DECISION

REPORT

Flag it to IT / Security (report-phishing button, ticket, or security@).

DECISION

IGNORE

Do nothing. Delete or dismiss it and move on.

DECISION

ESCALATE

Hand the decision to a manager or security lead for approval.

Score Tracker

Mark each meter's starting box, then move it as outcomes are revealed. The team survives by keeping all four in safe territory across 20 incidents.

Reputation

Public & customer trust. Lose at 0. Win-line: keep ≥ 50 .

Start at 70

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Funds (in thousands)

Company money. Bankrupt at 0. Win-line: keep > 0 .

Start at 100

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Security Score

How hardened you are. Fully breached at 0. Win-line: keep ≥ 40 .

Start at 60

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Stress (lower is better)

Team pressure. Burnout at 100. Win-line: keep ≤ 80 .

Start at 30

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Incident log

#	Decision	Outcome / Δ meters
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		

#	Decision	Outcome / Δ meters
11		
12		
13		
14		
15		
16		
17		
18		
19		
20		